



YOU ARE **14 WEEKS AND 3 DAYS**

179 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The hands are well developed at this stage, but, as can be seen here, the skin is very thin and transparent, which means the developing bones of the fingers and the blood vessels can be seen.

“Your baby’s external sex organs are now visible and it may be possible to identify gender from an ultrasound scan.”

Around this point in the second trimester, the sex of the baby’s external genitals has become apparent. When the genitals first began to form at around four weeks, they were the same in males and females. They consisted of a rounded bump called the genital tubercle and two ridges called labioscrotal swellings separated by a membrane. From around six weeks, differences started to occur driven by the presence or absence of a male (Y) [chromosome](#). By the 14th week, in boys the genital tubercle has elongated to become the penis and the labioscrotal swellings have fused to form the scrotum. In girls the labioscrotal swellings remain separate, forming the labia (lips), while the genital tubercle forms the clitoris.

ANIMAL MAGIC

Living with a cat or dog in early childhood may reduce the risk of developing asthma. Children residing with cats were more likely to have allergy-related antibodies to felines. Do not leave a baby alone with a dog or cat.

ASK A DOCTOR

How can I relieve my constipation? Constipation is a common symptom of pregnancy, mainly because progesterone slows down your bowel function, making everything more sluggish. Many women exercise less than usual during pregnancy, which can also cause things to become blocked. Finally, iron pills, which may be prescribed for anemia, can cause constipation. There are, thankfully, many ways to relieve it:

- **Eat more fiber:** Ensure that you are getting plenty of fiber in your diet, in the form of fresh fruit and vegetables and whole grains, and drink plenty of water.
- **Go natural:** Psyllium (or ispaghula), a common ingredient in some laxatives, appears to be safe during pregnancy, although studies in pregnant women have not been done.
- **Exercise regularly:** Exercise helps to reduce constipation.
- **Try reflexology:** Visit a registered therapist or do a little yourself at home. Massage the base of the heel and the arch, pushing your thumb evenly and deeply into the tissue of